

An attempt to answer common questions on maintenance matters raised by Stratford residents.

Q: How do I obtain help with a maintenance problem in my unit?

A: Contact the Front Desk to report your issue and/or request help. A work order will be generated in our TELS platform (work order/compliance application) with an alert to the Maintenance Department and ED. Once received, the unit owner will be contacted within 24 hours to:

- Address the minor issues directly or arrange a time to do so (e.g. Change a light bulb)

- For more complex problems, assess the situation and determine if it can be resolved internally. If external assistance is required, Maintenance can help you arrange for an approved contractor or you may engage one directly. Please be sure that outside contractors meet Stratford's insurance and licensing requirements.

Q: Who is financially responsible for maintenance of my unit?

A: Generally, maintenance needs within the unit are the responsibility of the unit owner. However, there are also items that are the responsibility of the Stratford. An attempt to define which items are part of the unit and which are not is set out at the end of this document. Regardless of who is responsible for work, the Stratford Maintenance Department is there to assist you in solving all maintenance issues.

Q: Does the Maintenance Department charge for such work?

A: There is no charge for work that requires less than 15 minutes (e.g. changing a light bulb, checking pendants batteries, etc). For projects that require more than 15 minutes that are the responsibility of the unit owner, for 2025 the fee is \$75 per hour billed in 15-minute increments. Charge for materials is additional. If an outside contractor performs the work, it is the responsibility of the unit owner to pay them directly.

Q. Does the Maintenance Department have a list of contractors that are approved to work at the Stratford?

A. Yes, the Maintenance Department maintains an updated list of approved contractors who meet Stratford's standards for licensing and insurance. Please contact either the Front Desk or Maintenance for the listing.

Q. Can the Maintenance Department assist with repairs to large kitchen and laundry appliances?

A. In unit appliances require a specially trained technician for repair work. Maintenance can assist in contacting the vendor if requested. If your item is still under warranty they will, upon request from you, contact the supplier/vendor.

Q. Is there some maintenance work that can only be done by outside contractors specified by Stratford? If so, how can we be assured that these contractors are charging reasonable prices and providing reasonable service? Does the Department contact these contractors and oversee their work in view of the fact that they have an exclusive arrangement?

A. The only work that requires a specified contractor is that involving the mechanics of the heat pump (heating and cooling of unit) located just outside of each unit. This contractor is very familiar with this complicated equipment and best to have Maintenance work with you in consultations or arranging for such work.

Q: Who is financially responsible for maintenance work in resident units?

A: Generally, the unit owner pays for work on items within the interior walls of the unit and the Stratford pays for maintenance throughout the rest of the building, known as common areas. Heat pumps are an exception to this rule as they are the owners' responsibility while a unit's glass windows, glass doors and the balconies are considered common areas. There are other exceptions to these designations as spelled out at the end of this paper.

Q. When you say the Stratford (as opposed to the unit owner) is financially responsible for common area repair or maintenance, precisely who is paying?

A: The simple answer is that such expenses in the common areas are divided among all unit owners. Routine repairs and maintenance are considered Stratford operating expenses which are reimbursed through our monthly Stratford dues. So all 67 unit owners in the building share this cost. Larger capital expenditure items are paid from the Laurel Avenue Trust.

Q. If I am remodeling my unit what is the role of the Maintenance Department?

A: Your contractor must coordinate with the Maintenance Department to become aware of conditions or requirements in the building that would affect or be involved in the proposed work. The Stratford must be satisfied that the contractor meets licensing and insurance requirements and is aware of the need to use quality

materials that meet Stratford standards. The maintenance Department will also monitor the project and assist when required (ie: water shut off needs, storage of tools and materials, parking, etc.). We request contractors to honor our request of working in the units between 8 AM – 4:40 PM.

Q. We have a clogged drain or sewer pipe in my unit. Is clearing that a responsibility of the Maintenance Department.

A: Be sure to advise the Concierge and/or the Maintenance Department immediately if there is a risk of a leak causing spillage into your unit. This can be done by pulling the emergency cord in your unit, or by pushing your neckware pendant or by calling the Concierge. The recent installation of Geevon sensors will emit a loud alarm sound, in this situation, please utilize your emergency pull cord to alert us. Please note that only human waste and toilet paper should be flushed down the toilets.

While the Maintenance Department will assist in stopping leaks and clearing clogs, if a clog is due to the Owner's negligence, improper use (e.g. disposal of inappropriate materials like grease, food waste or foreign objects down the drain) the unit owner is financially responsible for the unclogging and/or repair of the pipe.

Q. We have had damage to the interior of our unit. How do we arrange repairs?

A: A complicated subject. If the damage is from an inside source (ie, fire caused by a toaster) you should look for coverage from your homeowner's insurance policy. On the other hand, if the damage is from an external source (water leak from another unit or elsewhere in the building) it may be covered by a building property insurance policy maintained by the Homeowners Association, currently paid for by a monthly assessment. A meeting with the Stratford Controller is strongly suggested to help determine which policies come in to play and to organize meetings with your Homeowners Policy agent and/or Stratford's insurance adjustor and to arrange for necessary repairs.

Addendum From Stratford CC&Rs

...the boundaries of each Unit are the unfinished interior surfaces (exclusive of paint, wallpaper, wax, tile, enamel and other finishes) of the perimeter walls; floors; ceilings; windows, window frames and trim; doors, door frames and trim; and fireboxes. Each Unit includes both the non-structural portions of the Building included within the unfinished interior surfaces as defined above and as depicted in the Condominium Plan and the airspace encompassed therein. The following are not a part of the Unit: structural elements of the Building, including but not limited to: bearing walls, columns, floors, roof, foundation, and appurtenances thereto; balconies, hallways and stairs; central services; chutes, ducts, pipes, chimneys and flues; and drains, sewers, ventilators,

gas pipes, water pipes, conduits and wires, except for outlets, switches, fuses, fixtures and other utility installations located within a Unit. Each Unit specifically includes the range/oven, garbage disposal, interior partitions and utility fixtures installed therein. (CC&R 2.2(a)(i))

Repairs due to willful, reckless or negligent acts by the owner, their guests or invitees are the financial responsibility of the owner. (CC&R Section 8.6)